

ESTHER ADENUGA

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Computational Semantics and Pragmatics
- Multilingual Natural Language Processing (NLP)
- NLP for Low-Resource Languages
- Language Documentation and Preservation
- Computer-Assisted Language Learning

EDUCATION

- **B.A. Linguistics/French** 2023
University of Ibadan Ibadan, Oyo, Nigeria
 - Thesis: Machine Learning Approach to Yoruba Named Entity Recognition
 - Advisor: [Dr. Clement Odoje](#)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

- **NLP Research Fellow** Mar. 2025 - present
The African Research Collective (TARESCo), Lagos, Nigeria [\[🌐\]](#)
 - Co-led TARESCo's submission to the [MRL 2025 Shared Task](#): developed the dataset creation guide, coordinated annotators, and co-authored the accompanying paper.
 - Conduct linguistic data annotation, model evaluation, and dataset design for multiple projects advancing NLP for African languages.
 - Contribute to research writing, experiment design, and preparation of manuscripts for publication.
- **Phonetics Intern** Jul. 2023 - Aug. 2023
Living Tongues Institute for Endangered Languages, Salem, Oregon, USA [\[🌐\]](#)
 - Collaborated with a team under Dr. D.S. Anderson to conduct phonetic annotation and analysis of Mundari language speech samples using Praat.
- **Research Volunteer** Apr. 2020 - Nov. 2020
Tai Solarin University of Education, Ogun, Nigeria
 - Conducted literature reviews on Orientalism and Classical Mythology.
 - Synthesized research findings and edited thesis drafts adhering to MLA formatting style.

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

- **Online English Tutor** Jan. 2024 - Apr. 2025
Enrydyne Educational Services, UK [\[🌐\]](#)
 - Provided one-on-one tutoring to 15+ GCSE and A-level students in English Language and Literature, preparing progress reports for stakeholders.
- **Teacher** Sept. 2024 - Mar. 2025
Apostolic Faith Elementary School, Lagos, Nigeria
 - Instructed 3rd and 4th grade pupils in Literacy and French using Montessori and digital learning techniques.
- **Teacher** Aug. 2023 - Aug. 2024
Zion Pilgrims Christ School, Bauchi, Nigeria
 - Taught Literature-in-English to grades 7-12 and French to 80+ elementary students, improving average performance from 50% to 70%.
 - Served on prefectship and Christmas event committees.

PUBLICATIONS

- **Esther Adenuga**, Akintunde Oladipo, Odunayo Ogundepo, et al. (2025) Physical Commonsense Reasoning for West African Languages. In *Proceedings of the 5th Workshop on Multilingual Representation Learning (MRL)*, EMNLP 2025. (Accepted ; to appear)
- Odunayo Ogundepo, Akintunde Oladipo, Kelechi Ogueji, **Esther Adenuga**, David Ifeoluwa Adelani, and Jimmy Lin. (2025) [Improving Multilingual Math Reasoning for African Languages](#) (preprint)

SKILLS

- **Technical:** Python, Praat, ELAN, Lexique Pro, $\LaTeX$
- **Other Tools & Technologies:** Git, MS Office Suite
- **Languages:** English (Fluent), Yoruba (Native), French (Basic), American Sign Language (Conversational)

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND CERTIFICATES

• World Quant Applied Data Science Lab	<i>In Progress</i>
• ChatGPT Prompt Engineering for Developers – DeepLearning.AI	2025
• Linguistic Prompt Design Training	2024
• 120-Hour Teach English as a Foreign Language(TEFL) Certificate	2024
• Introduction to Natural Language Processing	2022
• Introduction to Programming using Python	2022

LEADERSHIP AND VOLUNTEERING EXPERIENCES

• Reviewer <i>2025 Naija Voices Language Heritage Micro-Grants </i>	<i>Jun. 2025</i>
◦ Reviewed proposals supporting African language preservation, assessing project clarity, feasibility, and impact using a standardized evaluation rubric.	
• Contributor <i>Google Crowdsourc</i>	<i>Dec. 2022 - Dec. 2024</i>
◦ Contributed to data labeling and validation for improved AI datasets.	
• Social Media Manager/Content Creator <i>Publicity and Editorial CDS, National Youth Service Corps (NYSC), Bauchi State, Nigeria</i>	<i>Jan. 2024 - June. 2024</i>
◦ Managed the NYSC Bauchi Facebook page, covering events such as orphanage visits and community sensitization programs.	
◦ Served as Advertising Manager for a 10-member team that produced the Bauchi State NYSC Magazine (Batch B, Stream 1 & 2, 2023).	
• District General Secretary <i>Apostolic Faith Campus Fellowship, Oyo State, Nigeria</i>	<i>Jan. 2022 - Jan. 2023</i>
◦ Coordinated secretaries from six tertiary institutions in Oyo State, collating and submitting reports to the national office.	
◦ Organized events and programs in collaboration with the state president and outreach secretary.	